HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "It was my fault"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"It was my fault." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who made the choices that caused harm?
- ☐ What did I know and what power did I have then?
- ☐ Would I blame a child or friend?
- ☐ Who told me it was my fault?
- ☐ Is there anything to confess, and anything to set down?
- ☐ What does God say about blame and the brokenhearted?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The guilt of another is not mine to carry.
- ☐ God is near to the brokenhearted.
- ☐ I did what I could with what I knew.
- ☐ Feeling guilty does not make me guilty.
- ☐ Jesus came to heal the brokenhearted.
- ☐ In Christ there is no condemnation.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Ezekiel 18:20**
  "The soul who sins is the one who will die. A son will not bear the iniquity of his father, and a father will not bear the iniquity of his son. The righteousness of the righteous man will fall upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked man will fall upon him."
- ☐ **Psalm 34:18**
  "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit."
- ☐ **Isaiah 61:1**
  "The Spirit of the Lord GOD is on Me, because the LORD has anointed Me to preach good news to the poor. He has sent Me to bind up the brokenhearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives and freedom to the prisoners."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Blame I set down: Each day, write one self-blaming thought and answer it with a truth from this card.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 34:18 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord is near to me when my heart is broken. I don't have to carry blame that isn't mine.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Guilt/Shame" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] Draw the responsibility pie. Draw a circle and divide it among everyone and everything that contributed to what happened. Notice how small, or empty, your slice really is.
- [ ] Write to your younger self. Write a short letter to yourself at the age it happened, telling that person what you know now.
- [ ] Tell a safe person. Share your story, or part of it, with a counselor, pastor, or trusted friend who will listen without blame.
- [ ] Get specialized help. If what happened was abuse or assault, a counselor trained in trauma can help you heal at a safe pace.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "It was my fault": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A time I set down blame
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~It was my fault.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have blamed myself for what happened for so long. Thank You that You are near to the brokenhearted. Help me lay down guilt that is not mine, confess what is, and receive Your healing and peace. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.